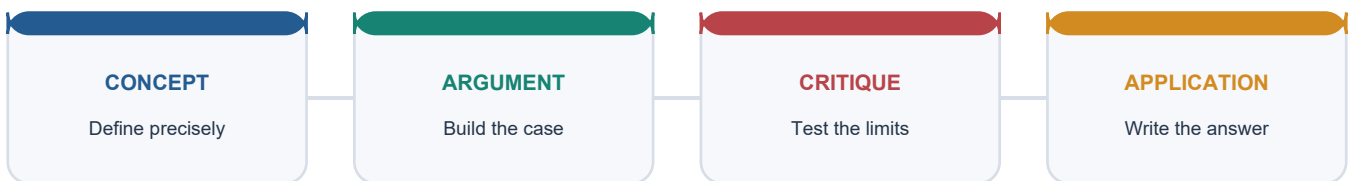


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Justice: Concepts and Dimensions - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Justice: Concepts and Dimensions - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 19 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Answer:?**

- A. Gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice
- B. Restores arithmetic equality after a wrong in a specific bilateral transaction - voluntary (contract, exchange) or involuntary (theft, injury).
- C. Argues that "justice" or "injustice" properly describes individual conduct within known rules, not the unplanned pattern of outcomes produced by a.
- D. Justice in the traditional sense means each part of the soul and each class in the state doing its proper function under rule of reason; Gauba treats this as a classic conservative/functional view

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: the source records this exact proposition - gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: restores arithmetic equality after a wrong in a specific bilateral transaction - voluntary (contract, is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **C:** C Source disagrees: argues that "justice" or "injustice" properly describes individual conduct within known rules, not the is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Misplaced: justice in the traditional sense means each part of the soul and each class in the state doing its proper is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups (Gauba, PDF pp.440-441).
- B. A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful (Gauba, PDF p.433).
- C. Justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or competition rules (Gauba, PDF pp.442-444).
- D. This asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker represents this line (Gauba, PDF p.440).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B This is the recorded association: the source records this exact proposition - a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Misplaced: justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: this asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify A society where existing arrangements may be criticized by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is A society where existing arrangements may be criticized.

MCQ 3

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections (Gauba, PDF pp.441-442).
- B. Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice (Gauba, PDF pp.439-440).
- C. This asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing law; Alf Ross represents this line
- D. Rawls is noted as a critic of utilitarianism and as a thinker who tries to accommodate substantive concerns within a procedural framework (Gauba, PDF pp.434-435, 443).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **B:** B Misplaced: justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - this asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing law; Alf Ross represents this line.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Rawls is noted as a critic of utilitarianism and as a thinker who tries to accommodate substantive concerns is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify This asks whether decisions are made by general rules by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is This asks whether decisions are made by general rules.

MCQ 4

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or competition rules (Gaub, PDF pp.442-444).
- B. Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups (Gaub, PDF pp.440-441).
- C. Moral entitlement earned through effort, sacrifice or voluntary contribution, distinct from raw ability (merit) or bare requirement (need).
- D. This asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker represents this line (Gaub, PDF p.440).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: moral entitlement earned through effort, sacrifice or voluntary contribution, distinct from raw ability is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - this asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker represents this line.

Examiner trap: Do not identify This asks whether the law itself has moral value and by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is This asks whether the law itself has moral value and.

MCQ 5

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- B. This asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing law; Alf Ross represents this line (Gaub, PDF pp.439-440).
- C. Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections (Gaub, PDF pp.441-442).
- D. Rawls is noted as a critic of utilitarianism and as a thinker who tries to accommodate substantive concerns within a procedural framework (Gaub, PDF pp.434-435, 443).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: this asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Not this pair: rawls is noted as a critic of utilitarianism and as a thinker who tries to accommodate substantive concerns is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair.

MCQ 6

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful (Gaub, PDF p.433).
- B. Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups (Gaub, PDF pp.440-441).
- C. Justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or competition rules (Gaub, PDF pp.442-444).
- D. This asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker represents this line (Gaub, PDF p.440).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.
- **C:** C Not this pair: justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: this asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Transformation of institutions by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Transformation of institutions.

MCQ 7

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Justice is the integrating principle behind liberty, equality and fraternity, and law gains true force when validity is joined with moral value (Gaub, PDF pp.436-440).
- B. Rawls is noted as a critic of utilitarianism and as a thinker who tries to accommodate substantive concerns within a procedural framework (Gaub, PDF pp.434-435, 443).
- C. Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections
- D. This asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing law; Alf Ross represents this line (Gaub, PDF pp.439-440).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: justice is the integrating principle behind liberty, equality and fraternity, and law gains true force when is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Not this pair: rawls is noted as a critic of utilitarianism and as a thinker who tries to accommodate substantive concerns is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source-exact: the source records this exact proposition - reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: this asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Reordering social and economic relations so that by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Reordering social and economic relations so that.

MCQ 8

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups (Gaub, PDF pp.440-441).
- B. This asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker represents this line (Gaub, PDF p.440).
- C. Moral entitlement earned through effort, sacrifice or voluntary contribution, distinct from raw ability (merit) or bare requirement (need).
- D. Justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or competition rules (Gaub, PDF pp.442-444).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: this asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: moral entitlement earned through effort, sacrifice or voluntary contribution, distinct from raw ability is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: the source records this exact proposition - justice secured through fair rules, impartial application and non-cheating, often modeled on market or competition rules.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Justice secured through fair rules by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Justice secured through fair rules.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Misplaced: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Open society.

MCQ 11

Which pair keeps the proposition with the name or concept the source attaches it to?

- A. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Justice.

MCQ 12

Which pairing is exact, rather than borrowed from an adjacent part of the same topic?

- A. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections
- D. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Legal justice.

MCQ 13

One pairing below is faithful to the source. Which one?

- A. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and.

MCQ 14

Which label-proposition pair would not be corrected by the source text?

- A. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- B. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- C. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.

- **C:** C Not this pair: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures.

MCQ 15

Which of the following associations is reproduced exactly as recorded?

- A. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 3: Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and.

MCQ 16

Which pair matches its proposition without drifting to a related concept?

- A. Justice - A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful
- B. Open society - Justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice
- C. Legal justice - Transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups
- D. Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Justice is recorded with gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Open society is recorded with a society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Legal justice is recorded with justice in the legal sphere may mean either fair administration according to existing law or testing law itself against standards of justice.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Political justice is recorded with transformation of institutions, rights and procedures so that political power reflects the people rather than privileged groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Political justice - Reordering social and economic relations so that; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Political justice.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Restores arithmetic equality after a wrong in a specific bilateral transaction - voluntary (contract, exchange) or involuntary (theft, injury, fraud) - by correcting unjust gain and loss irrespective of the parties' relative merit or social standing.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Nancy Fraser analyses injustice through redistribution and recognition under the normative aim of parity of participation; her mature framework also adds representation. She should not be treated as the originator of every recognition theory. This file uses her framework only as a boundary marker for where distributive analysis requires status and political-representation analysis.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Demonstrated ability, achievement or performance (e.g., examination rank, productivity).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Demonstrated ability, achievement or performance (e.g., examination rank, productivity).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only

- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 2 only.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Treats voluntary market exchange under freedom of contract as itself the fair procedure; if an exchange is uncoerced, its outcome is procedurally legitimate regardless of the resulting inequality.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Basic requirements for a decent life (subsistence, health, education) regardless of contribution or ability.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Moral entitlement earned through effort, sacrifice or voluntary contribution, distinct from raw ability (merit) or bare requirement (need).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: This asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing law; Alf Ross represents this line (Gaub, PDF pp.439-440).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Demonstrated ability, achievement or performance (e.g., examination rank, productivity).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: This asks whether the law itself has moral value and conforms to what is right-in-itself; Ernest Barker represents this line (Gaubu, PDF p.440).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 1 only.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice (Gaubu, PDF pp.432-433).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Gauba introduces justice through the fair allocation of benefits and burdens, especially where valued goods are scarce and criteria are open to contestation; this is his chapter frame, not an exhaustive definition of every form of justice (Gaubu, PDF pp.432-433).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.

- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: 2 only.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Moral entitlement earned through effort, sacrifice or voluntary contribution, distinct from raw ability (merit) or bare requirement (need).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: A society where existing arrangements may be criticized and revised through public reasoning, making the search for justice meaningful (Gaub, PDF p.433).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: This asks whether decisions are made by general rules, applied impartially and efficiently under existing law; Alf Ross represents this line (Gaub, PDF pp.439-440).
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Reordering social and economic relations so that exploitation is checked and the material and moral gains of social life reach weaker sections (Gaub, PDF pp.441-442).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Justice is only whatever the law says.?**

- A. Gauba explicitly distinguishes legal validity from moral value and prefers a richer view where law must also answer to justice (Gauba, PDF p.440).
- B. They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.
- C. Gauba treats it as a structural and rights-based transformation of social conditions, especially for the oppressed and underprivileged (Gauba, PDF pp.438-442).
- D. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gauba, PDF pp.442-445).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly distinguishes legal validity from moral value and prefers a richer view where law must also answer to justice (Gauba, PDF p.440).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition perspectives as fully resolved inside this conceptual file.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Social justice means only welfare charity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Procedural fairness settles everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Justice is only whatever the law says, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Social justice means only welfare charity.?**

- A. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gauba, PDF pp.442-445); this formulation is presented as sufficient for the classification.
- B. Gauba treats it as a structural and rights-based transformation of social conditions, especially for the oppressed and underprivileged (Gauba, PDF pp.438-442).
- C. They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.
- D. Gauba explicitly distinguishes legal validity from moral value and prefers a richer view where law must also answer to justice (Gauba, PDF p.440).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Procedural fairness settles everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba treats it as a structural and rights-based transformation of social conditions, especially for the oppressed and underprivileged (Gauba, PDF pp.438-442).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition perspectives as fully resolved inside this conceptual file.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Justice is only whatever the law says.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Social justice means only welfare charity, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Procedural fairness settles everything.**?

- A. Barker's central point is that justice orders and reconciles them into one coherent scheme (Gaubu, PDF pp.436-438).
- B. They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.
- C. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gaubu, PDF pp.442-445).
- D. Gauba explicitly distinguishes legal validity from moral value and prefers a richer view where law must also answer to justice (Gaubu, PDF p.440).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberty, equality and fraternity are separate slogans to be listed one after another.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition perspectives as fully resolved inside this conceptual file.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gaubu, PDF pp.442-445).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Justice is only whatever the law says.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Procedural fairness settles everything, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Substantive justice can ignore due process.**?

- A. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gaubu.
- B. It is about the logic of justice that later informs constitutional and policy discussions.
- C. Barker's central point is that justice orders and reconciles them into one coherent scheme (Gaubu, PDF pp.436-438).
- D. Gauba does not reject procedure; he rejects the claim that procedure alone is enough.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Procedural fairness settles everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not reduce this file to constitutional provisions alone.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberty, equality and fraternity are separate slogans to be listed one after another.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba does not reject procedure; he rejects the claim that procedure alone is enough.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Substantive justice can ignore due process, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Liberty, equality and fraternity are separate slogans to be listed one after another.?**

- A. Barker's central point is that justice orders and reconciles them into one coherent scheme (Gaubu, PDF pp.436-438).
- B. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gaubu, PDF pp.442-445).
- C. It is about the logic of justice that later informs constitutional and policy discussions.
- D. They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Barker's central point is that justice orders and reconciles them into one coherent scheme (Gaubu, PDF pp.436-438).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Procedural fairness settles everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not reduce this file to constitutional provisions alone.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition perspectives as fully resolved inside this conceptual file.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Liberty, equality and fraternity are separate, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Do not reduce this file to constitutional provisions alone.?**

- A. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gaubu, PDF pp.442-445).
- B. It is about the logic of justice that later informs constitutional and policy discussions.
- C. Barker's central point is that justice orders and reconciles them into one coherent scheme (Gaubu, PDF pp.436-438).
- D. Gaubu does not reject procedure; he rejects the claim that procedure alone is enough.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Procedural fairness settles everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: It is about the logic of justice that later informs constitutional and policy discussions.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberty, equality and fraternity are separate slogans to be listed one after another.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive justice can ignore due process.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Do not reduce this file to constitutional provisions, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Do not duplicate the full original-position/veil-of-ignorance/difference-principle architecture in this file.?**

- A. Gauba treats it as a structural and rights-based transformation of social conditions, especially for the oppressed and underprivileged (Gauba, PDF pp.438-442).
- B. Gauba explicitly distinguishes legal validity from moral value and prefers a richer view where law must also answer to justice (Gauba, PDF p.440).
- C. Use the answer-complete Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md; its Advanced companion is optional enrichment. This file's job is only.
- D. They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Social justice means only welfare charity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Justice is only whatever the law says.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Use the answer-complete Political-Theory/basic/20_Diverse-Perspectives-on-Justice.md; its Advanced companion is optional enrichment. This file's job is only to flag the bridge so that Sections 5 and 14 are not read as forcing a strict procedural/substantive either-or.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition perspectives as fully resolved inside this conceptual file.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Do not duplicate the full original-position/veil-of, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition perspectives as fully resolved inside this conceptual file.?**

- A. A fair-looking procedure can still operate inside severe inequality and leave outcomes unjust (Gauba, PDF pp.442-445).
- B. Gauba explicitly distinguishes legal validity from moral value and prefers a richer view where law must also answer to justice (Gauba, PDF p.440).
- C. Gauba treats it as a structural and rights-based transformation of social conditions, especially for the oppressed and underprivileged (Gauba, PDF pp.438-442).
- D. They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Procedural fairness settles everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Justice is only whatever the law says.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Social justice means only welfare charity.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: They are flagged as necessary companion lenses; full development belongs to the Feminism file and to Topic 20's diverse-perspectives treatment.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Do not treat feminist/capability/recognition, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Justice concerns rightness rather than mere utility and orders liberty, equality and fraternity. Explain. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *discuss* requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of concerns rightness rather than mere utility and orders liberty, equality and fraternity. Explain in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Barker and Liberty, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that formal equality also remains shallow where unequal bargaining power and deprivation persist.

Model answer (147 words):

Introduction: Gauba introduces justice as a standard of right allocation rather than a simple calculation of aggregate advantage. The claim does not make every utilitarian account impossible; it rejects the sacrifice of what is right merely because doing so produces a larger total benefit. Core analysis: Barker supplies the ordering principle. Liberty cannot mean an unlimited licence through which the stronger destroys another's freedom, so it must be equal and regulated. Formal equality also remains shallow where unequal bargaining power and deprivation persist. Fraternity then converts concern for weaker members from discretionary charity into a claim arising from common social life. A good answer therefore uses the triad as a test of arrangements, not as three decorative slogans. Conclusion: Justice is therefore not another isolated ideal: it is the reasoned ordering that protects equal liberty, corrects structural inequality and turns fraternity from charity into reciprocal social membership.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Barker and Liberty), converts that evidence into analysis of concerns rightness rather than mere utility and orders liberty, equality and fraternity. Explain, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that formal equality also remains shallow where unequal bargaining power and deprivation persist. At 147 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish Aristotle's distributive and corrective justice. Why should neither be confused with retributive or restorative justice? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *distinguish* requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of Aristotle's distributive and corrective justice. Why should neither be confused with retributive or restorative justice in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Aristotle, Core and Distributive, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Aristotle's distinction remains analytically useful only when allocation and bilateral rectification are kept separate from the penal aims of censure, punishment, repair and reconciliation.

Model answer (146 words):

Introduction: Aristotle separates justice in the distribution of common advantages from justice that corrects a wrong between particular parties. The distinction concerns different objects, standards and institutional tasks. Core analysis:

Distributive justice allocates offices, honours or goods according to geometric proportion and a relevant standard of worth. Corrective justice restores arithmetic equality in a bilateral transaction by correcting unjust gain and loss without ranking the parties by merit. Retributive justice instead concerns proportionate censure or punishment for wrongdoing, while restorative justice seeks repair of harm, responsibility and restored relations through a wider process. The latter two belong to penal philosophy and cannot be inferred merely from Aristotle's transactional correction. Maintaining the boundaries prevents one vocabulary from silently answering four different questions. Conclusion: Aristotle's distinction remains analytically useful only when allocation and bilateral rectification are kept separate from the penal aims of censure, punishment, repair and reconciliation.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Aristotle, Core and Distributive), converts that evidence into analysis of Aristotle's distributive and corrective justice. Why should neither be confused with retributive or restorative justice, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Aristotle's distinction remains analytically useful only when allocation and bilateral rectification are kept separate from the penal aims of censure, punishment, repair and reconciliation. At 146 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish justice according to law from law according to justice. Show how legal, political and socio-economic justice expose the limits of mere legality. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of justice according to law from law according to justice. Show how legal, political and socio-economic justice expose the limits of mere legality in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Justice, Law and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Legality is indispensable for non-arbitrary rule, but justice requires institutions whose content, distribution of power and material consequences can also withstand moral and democratic scrutiny.

Model answer (149 words):

Introduction: Justice according to law asks whether valid rules are general, efficiently administered and impartially applied. Law according to justice asks the prior question whether those rules possess defensible moral value. Core analysis: Alf Ross represents the first concern and Ernest Barker the second. Legal justice requires both non-arbitrary administration and scrutiny of legal content. Political justice tests whether institutions, rights, criticism and association distribute public power democratically rather than preserving privileged control. Socio-economic justice asks whether exploitation, deprivation and unequal material power hollow out formally equal legal and political status. A rule may therefore be impeccably administered while excluding a group from effective voice, courts or social opportunity. The defensible settlement joins legality, public justification and institutional procedures for criticism and reform. Conclusion: Legality is indispensable for non-arbitrary rule, but justice requires institutions whose content, distribution of power and material consequences can also withstand moral and democratic scrutiny.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Justice, Law and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of justice according to law from law according to justice. Show how legal, political and socio-economic justice expose the limits of mere legality, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Legality is indispensable for non-arbitrary rule, but justice requires institutions whose content, distribution of power and material consequences can also withstand moral and democratic scrutiny. At 149 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Is fair procedure sufficient for justice? Discuss through procedural liberalism, Macpherson's criticism and the substantive-justice response. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive is requires the answer to take a side, defend it and concede the strongest point against it. Fix the boundary of fair procedure sufficient for justice? Discuss through procedural liberalism, Macpherson's criticism and the substantive-justice response in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Procedural, Core and Hayek, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Fair procedure is necessary but insufficient: rules earn legitimacy only when background power does not convert formally equal participation into predictable exclusion and when a defensible social minimum is secured.

Model answer (176 words):

Introduction: Procedural justice protects general rules, impartial application and freedom from force or fraud. These safeguards are indispensable because outcome-focused authority without due process can become arbitrary. Core analysis: Gauba groups Hayek, Friedman and Nozick as procedure-centred liberals, although their doctrines differ: Hayek defends general rules and spontaneous order, Friedman voluntary exchange, and Nozick a historical entitlement theory of acquisition, transfer and rectification. Macpherson's objection targets the background conditions under which such procedures operate. Severe inequality can make a formally voluntary contract the product of dependence and can deny ordinary people the developmental freedom required for meaningful competition. Substantive justice therefore adds minimum needs, usable opportunity and attention to weaker parties. Critical evaluation: Substance cannot erase procedure, and unequal outcomes do not automatically prove injustice. The qualified conclusion is that procedure is necessary but must be tested against background power and a defensible social floor. Conclusion: Fair procedure is necessary but insufficient: rules earn legitimacy only when background power does not convert formally equal participation into predictable exclusion and when a defensible social minimum is secured.

Why this earns marks: it obeys is instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Procedural, Core and Hayek), converts that evidence into analysis of fair procedure sufficient for justice? Discuss through procedural liberalism, Macpherson's criticism and the substantive-justice response, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Fair procedure is necessary but insufficient: rules earn legitimacy only when background power does not convert formally equal participation into predictable exclusion and when a defensible social minimum is secured. At 176 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Rawls, Nozick and Sen on the procedure, object and institutional requirements of justice. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of Rawls, Nozick and Sen on the procedure, object and institutional requirements of justice in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Rawls, Nozick and Sen, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that their standards remain rival: capability comparison cannot simply be inserted into entitlement, and rectification does not settle the design of fair institutions.

Model answer (243 words):

Introduction: Rawls, Nozick and Sen disagree about what justice evaluates, how its principles are selected and what institutions must do. Their theories should therefore be compared through procedure, object and remedy rather than placed on one left-right scale. Core analysis: Rawls uses the original position and veil of ignorance to select two ordered principles governing the basic structure: equal basic liberties have priority, while the second principle contains fair equality of opportunity before the difference principle. Nozick rejects patterned end-state allocation and asks whether holdings arose through just acquisition and transfer, with rectification for historical injustice under a Lockean proviso. Sen shifts attention from ideal institutional design and resource shares to capabilities, actual lives, remediable injustice and comparative public reasoning. Further development: Their temporal orientations differ as well. Rawls asks which enduring principles should regulate a fair basic structure; Nozick reconstructs the history that produced present holdings; Sen compares actual states to identify remediable injustice. A complete evaluation therefore distinguishes ideal design, historical legitimacy and practical improvement. Critical evaluation: Rawls supplies a demanding institutional benchmark, Nozick exposes the importance of history and coercion, and Sen reveals informational and realisation gaps. Their standards remain rival: capability comparison cannot simply be inserted into entitlement, and rectification does not settle the design of fair institutions. Conclusion: The strongest synthesis keeps Rawls's fair institutional structure, Nozick's historical and rectificatory challenge, and Sen's comparative attention to actual capability while refusing to collapse their rival standards into one formula.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Rawls, Nozick and Sen), converts that evidence into analysis of Rawls, Nozick and Sen on the procedure, object and institutional requirements of justice, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that their standards remain rival: capability comparison cannot simply be inserted into entitlement, and rectification does not settle the design of fair institutions. At 243 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Modern social justice requires redistribution, recognition, representation and duties beyond present national citizens. Critically examine with reference to affirmative action and global, intergenerational and environmental justice. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *discuss* requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of social justice requires redistribution, recognition, representation and duties beyond present national citizens. Critically examine with reference to affirmative action and global, intergenerational and environmental justice in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Modern, Distribution and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Modern justice must connect resources, status and political voice across time and borders, but every extension still requires specified duty-bearers, accountable institutions and safeguards against both exclusion and paternalism.

Model answer (235 words):

Introduction: Modern social justice expands the question of fair shares into status, political voice and the temporal and territorial reach of obligation. Distribution alone cannot explain every patterned exclusion. Core analysis: Redistribution addresses resources and opportunities; recognition addresses institutionalised status injury; representation asks who can participate as a peer in framing binding rules. Fraser's mature framework connects these dimensions through parity of participation. Affirmative action is therefore better justified through substantive equality, anti-subordination, representation and historical exclusion than as ordinary need-based welfare. Global justice asks how cross-border institutions and inequalities generate duties, while intergenerational and environmental justice test whether present benefits externalise irreversible burdens onto future persons and ecological systems. The 2026-27 National Overseas Scholarship can illustrate group-sensitive opportunity and representation without proving any one theory. Further development: Representation also determines who defines the relevant harm. Future persons and distant populations cannot participate on ordinary electoral terms, so institutions need trusteeship, public reason, scientific evidence and review without pretending to speak infallibly for absent interests. This makes accountability a central part of expanded justice. A defensible approach specifies the institution causing or capable of remedying harm, protects agency, and subjects group-sensitive measures to transparent review rather than assuming every unequal outcome requires one identical remedy. Conclusion: Modern justice must connect resources, status and political voice across time and borders, but every extension still requires specified duty-bearers, accountable institutions and safeguards against both exclusion and paternalism.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Modern, Distribution and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of social justice requires redistribution, recognition, representation and duties beyond present national citizens. Critically examine with reference to affirmative action and global, intergenerational and environmental justice, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Modern justice must connect resources, status and political voice across time and borders, but every extension still requires specified duty-bearers, accountable institutions and safeguards against both exclusion and paternalism. At 235 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
